

Phishing Awareness & Detection Kit

Project Type: Educational cybersecurity awareness resource

Purpose: Teach users how to identify, avoid, and report common phishing attempts safely.

1. What is Phishing?

Phishing is a social-engineering attack in which an attacker impersonates a trusted person or organization to trick a user into revealing information, clicking a harmful link, opening an attachment, or making a payment.

2. Common Phishing Techniques

Email phishing, smishing (SMS/messages), vishing (voice calls), spear phishing, QR phishing, and impersonation are common techniques.

3. Warning Signs

Urgency, unusual sender addresses, generic greetings, unexpected attachments, suspicious links, poor spelling, and requests for passwords, OTPs, PINs, or payment are important warning signs.

4. Suspicious Links and Domains

Users should inspect the actual destination/domain before clicking. Misspellings, unrelated domains, extra words, or unexpected subdomains can indicate deception. HTTPS alone does not prove a site is trustworthy.

5. Fake Login Pages & Social Engineering

Fake login pages often imitate familiar branding. Unexpected login prompts, unfamiliar domains, pressure tactics, and requests for credentials are warning signs.

6. Safe Password and Account Practices

Use unique passwords/passphrases, consider a reputable password manager, never share passwords or OTPs, keep recovery information updated, review active sessions, and keep software updated.

7. Multi-Factor Authentication

MFA adds a second verification step. Authenticator apps, passkeys, and security keys can provide stronger protection. MFA codes should never be shared with unexpected callers or messages.

8. Reporting Suspicious Messages

Do not interact with suspicious content. Use the service's report-phishing/spam function, notify the appropriate IT/security team, and contact organizations through official channels.

9. Harmless Example Scenarios

Scenario A: A fake delivery text asks for \$25 through example.test/pay. Verify through the official delivery service instead.

Scenario B: A fake college notice threatens scholarship cancellation and asks you to log in at

example.test/login. Verify through the official college portal.

Scenario C: A caller claims to be support and asks for an OTP. Do not share it; contact support through an official channel.

10. Short Quiz

- 1) What is phishing?
- 2) Give two warning signs of a suspicious email.
- 3) Why inspect a link's domain?
- 4) Should an OTP be shared with an unexpected caller?
- 5) Give one benefit of MFA.
- 6) What should you do after receiving a suspicious message?

Safety & Ethics

All examples in this project are educational and harmless. They use example.test domains and do not collect passwords, personal information, payment details, or credentials. Never include real secrets or API keys in a submission.